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Greg Howard
4217 Deland Avenue
Columbus, OH 43214

Dear Greg,

I saw your name on the track alumni email chain last week and nearly jumped out of my chair. You signed up for the Columbus Half Marathon! I have been grinning about it ever since. You always had that quiet determination in you, and I knew distance would suit you eventually.

I still think about those 400 hurdle workouts on a Tuesday afternoon when the field was wet and you would just lock in. Your sense of pace was something I rarely saw in a high school athlete. That patience you had between the barriers is exactly what the first two miles of a half marathon demand. The biggest mistake most runners make is going out too fast. Trust the corral, trust your training, and let the faster runners go. You will pass half of them by mile nine.

A few practical notes from a woman who has watched too many runners hobble across finish lines: start your dynamic warm-up at least 20 minutes before your wave. Hip circles, leg swings, a slow jog. Your right hamstring has done so much work over the years and it deserves that extra care. Fuel before mile six even if you do not feel like you need it.

I am planning to come up to Columbus in November 2026 and I would love to take you and Derek to lunch and hear all about the race. Please give my warm regards to him. I hope the school year is treating him well.

I am so proud of you, Greg. Keep going.

With pride and a few extra hamstring reminders,

Diane

P.S. Make sure you do that dynamic warm-up before the race. Your right hamstring will thank you.